AI CV Matching Project

Student briefing: the project and your role

Second Talent · Presented by Eric Cheng (Chief of Staff) · Fri 30 Oct 2026

1 Why this project

- Second Talent places talent for clients through recruitment, secondment and EOR.
- We are building an **HRIS platform**. One feature is **AI candidate matching**: a client describes a role, and the system suggests the best-fit profiles.
- **70–80% of our roles are tech** (AI, front-end, back-end, full-stack), so the project focuses on tech.
- Recruiters match CVs by hand today, which takes a lot of time. AI can shortlist faster.

2 The goal

> Give the system a **job description (JD)** and get back a **ranked shortlist of CVs**, each with a short reason, that an experienced Second Talent recruiter would agree with.

3 Your role

① Prepare the data
Collect anonymised tech JDs and CVs, plus about 50 recruiter-approved "good match" pairs.

② Write the matching guide
Explain what to extract from a CV and a JD, and how much each factor matters.

③ Build a baseline
A simple matcher plus a test showing how often it picks the right person.

4 Scope

✓ In scope

- Tech roles first
- Anonymised Manatal JDs and CVs
- Labelled CV–JD pairs
- AI extraction (e.g. Claude) and a baseline model

✗ Out of scope (for now)

- Any un-masked personal data
- Building the live HRIS feature
- Buying or scraping LinkedIn data without approval
- Sales roles

5 How CV matching works, in plain words

1. Read JD Make a checklist of what the role needs → **2. Read CV** Pull out the same facts about the person → **3. Filter** Remove clear no-gos (location, notice period, language) → **4. Score** Add up a weighted score for each factor → **5. Rank** Show the top 5 with a reason for each

- An **AI model** reads messy CV PDFs and fills in a fixed form. A **machine learning model** then learns from labelled pairs which matches are good.

6 What recruiters look at

Weight	Factors
Highest	Hard skills overlap (must-have vs nice-to-have) · Years of relevant experience
High	Seniority level (junior / mid / senior / lead) · Expected salary vs budget
Medium	Industry / domain background · Job stability (tenure, gaps) · Education or certificates (only if the role needs them)
Filters	Location, time zone, remote eligibility · Notice period · English and other languages

These weights are a rough guide. We'll agree the final numbers with the recruitment team.

7 Data & tools

- **Manatal** (our ATS): the main source of CVs (PDF) and JDs. We also source from LinkedIn Recruiter and Juicebox.
- **Starting sheet:** "Manatal Examples – JD & CV (anonymised)" has **50 JDs** and **100 CVs**, with no match labels yet.
- **Target: 100–200 tech JDs** and **about 50 good-match CV–JD pairs**.
- **Tools:** Claude for extraction and masking. Python, pandas, embeddings and Google Sheets for labelling.

> **Privacy rule:** mask names, emails, phones, addresses, photos and LinkedIn URLs **before** any data leaves Second Talent. Check by hand. Nothing gets shared until Eric approves it.